

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 973

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the eightieth anniversary of the iconic Bozo, The World's Most Famous Clown.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take pleasure in recognizing an iconic figure who has brought joy and laughter to the American public for eighty years, namely Bozo, The World's Most Famous Clown; and

WHEREAS, created by Alan W. Livingston of Capitol Records, Bozo the Clown first appeared in 1946 as the narrator for a children's read-along record set; Pinto Colvig voiced the character and brought Bozo to life; and

WHEREAS, Bozo the Clown was an instant hit and became the mascot of Capitol Records' children's offerings; and

WHEREAS, in 1957, Larry Harmon, one of many actors hired by Capitol to portray Bozo the Clown, bought the character from the record company and revamped the character with a new look, new voice, and new name: Bozo, The World's Most Famous Clown; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Harmon then began producing cartoon shorts featuring the "new" Bozo, voicing the character himself, and licensed these shorts, along with Bozo franchises, to local television stations across the country, with various performers appearing as the character; and

WHEREAS, the most famous local version was Chicago's *Bozo Show*, which featured Bob Bell as The World's Most Famous Clown and aired on WGN from 1960 to 2001, not only locally but also on the WGN Superstation that was a staple of cable television nationally; and

WHEREAS, today, Bozo the Clown is intimately connected with the Volunteer State, as noted actor and Tennessee resident David Arquette acquired the rights to the iconic character from Larry Harmon Pictures in 2021 after a fifteen-year pursuit; and

WHEREAS, a lifelong fan of Bozo the Clown, Mr. Arquette aims to revive the character through new media and circus-style experiences; and

WHEREAS, delighting in Bozo the Clown's "childlike spirit," David Arquette is personally invested in the character's legacy, often appearing in the classic Bozo makeup and supporting charity work through the persona; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Arquette's initial love of clowns stemmed from his dad, actor Lewis Arquette, who often appeared as Butter the Clown at his son's birthday parties; and

WHEREAS, David Arquette has studied the art of clowning with Misha Usov and revels in the child-like amazement and laughter the art form celebrates; and

WHEREAS, David Arquette has dedicated himself to "spreading happiness and joy and making people laugh" through the Bozo the Clown character, and he is worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we commemorate the eightieth anniversary of Bozo, The World's Most Famous Clown, fondly recalling the pleasure he has brought to children and adults alike over the years.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we commend David Arquette for his work in revitalizing Bozo the Clown and restoring the character to his rightful iconic stature in American popular culture.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.